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Observe continues to
adapt to the changing
world of software
observability



Rebecca Szkutak — 6:00 AM PDT · July 30, 2025

Observe, an observability platform, was founded in 2017 in response to the changing nature of software observability. Companies started pushing out new versions of their software more frequently — and producing significantly more data because of it.

Now Observe is responding to the latest big shift in technology. AI.

San Mateo-based Observe helps companies get an inside look at the status of their software, which makes it easier for engineers to spot and solve disruptions and outages.

The recent advancements in AI are both a blessing and a burden for the company. Observe's observability product incorporates AI agents to help make finding and fixing issues faster for its customers. But advancements in AI mean companies are shipping software even faster than before and seeing their data balloon because of it.

CEO Jeremy Burton told TechCrunch that with the continual advancement of AI agents, observability continues to get more complex.

"In a few years, you're going to have hundreds or thousands of agents on your network that are all interacting with employees or interacting with each other," Burton said. "That's all great until something goes wrong, and you've got to try and, you know, do

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a Sherlock Holmes and figure out who done it, you know?”

But Observe is adapting to how the industry is changing, Burton said. The company released a Model Context Protocol (MCP) server earlier this year that allows developers to access their observability data from AI coding tools and large language models. This is to help meet developers where they are already working, Burton said, and help them accomplish tasks easier.

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“We have customers already that are using the MCP server and really trying fairly radical workflows,” Burton said. “They’re sitting in their development environment, and they say, ‘Hey, take a look at this ticket. Use Observe to go figure out what’s happening, and then describe to me the code that you think is problematic, and then suggest the fix.’ That would have been in the realm of science fiction even a year ago.”

The company is also working toward supporting Apache Iceberg, an open source data table format that allows businesses to own and standardize their own data. Burton said companies really like that approach, and Observe expects to be able to support that format by the end of the year.

The company's revenue nearly tripled in 2024, and it saw 93% gross retention of its customers, although Burton declined to share specific numbers. The company counts large enterprises, including CapitalOne, Paramount, and Dialpad, as customers.

Observe raised \$156 million in a Series C round led by Sutter Hill Ventures with participation from Madrona Ventures, Alumni Ventures, and strategic investors like Snowflake, among others.

The company will put the capital toward research and development and hiring. Observe hopes to roll out its private preview for Apache Iceberg support shortly.

"We've got a couple of really good things out there, but I feel like we've just gotten started," Burton said.

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Rebecca Szkutak

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Becca is a senior writer at TechCrunch that covers venture capital trends and startups. She previously covered the...

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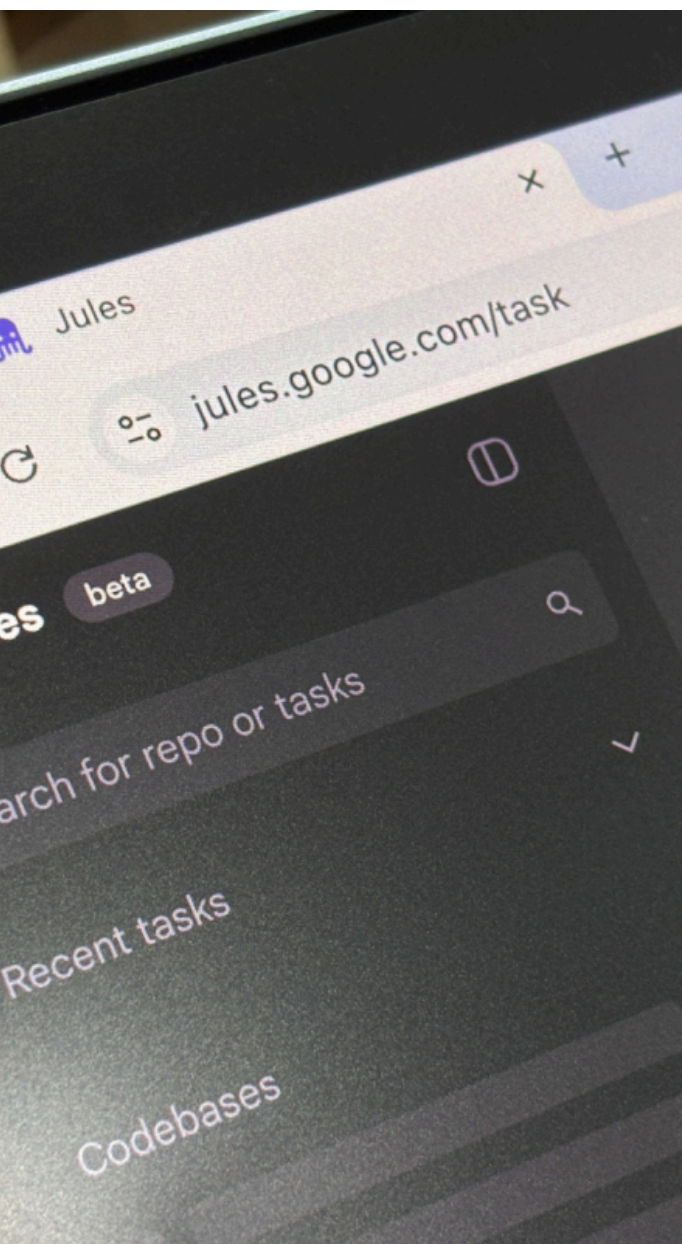


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AI

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Google's AI coding agent Jules is now out of beta

Jagmeet Singh — 9:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Google on Wednesday launched its AI coding agent, Jules, out of beta, just over two months after its [public preview debut in May](#).

Powered by Gemini 2.5 Pro, Jules is an asynchronous, agent-based coding tool that integrates with GitHub, clones codebases into

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Google Cloud virtual machines, and uses AI to fix or update code while developers focus on other tasks.

Google [initially announced](#) Jules as a Google Labs project in December and made it [available to beta testers](#) through a public preview at its I/O developer conference.

Kathy Korevec, director of product at Google Labs, told TechCrunch that the tool's improved stability drove the decision to take it out of beta after receiving hundreds of UI and quality updates during its beta phase.

"The trajectory of where we're going gives us a lot of confidence that Jules is around and going to be around for the long haul," she said.

With the wider rollout, Google introduced structured pricing tiers for Jules, starting with an "introductory access" free plan capped at 15 individual daily tasks and three concurrent ones, down from the 60-task limit during beta. Jules' paid tiers are part of the Google AI Pro and Ultra plans, which are priced at \$19.99 and \$124.99 a month, and offer subscribers 5x and 20x higher limits, respectively.

Korevec noted that Jules' packaging and pricing are based on "real usage" insights gathered over the past couple of months.

"The 60-task cap helped us study how developers use Jules and gave us the information we needed to design the new packaging," she said. "The 15/day is designed to give people a sense of whether Jules will work for them on real project tasks."

Google also updated Jules' privacy policy to be more explicit about how it trains AI. If a repository is public, its data may be used for training, but if it is private, Korevec said that no data is sent.

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“We got a little bit of feedback from users that it [the privacy policy] wasn’t as clear as we thought it was, and so most of it is just responding to that. We didn’t change anything about what we’re doing on the training side, but we changed the language,” Korevec said.

During the beta, Google said that thousands of developers tackled tens of thousands of tasks, resulting in over 140,000 code improvements shared publicly. Initial feedback led the Google Labs team to add new capabilities, including reusing previous setups for faster task execution, integrating with GitHub issues, and supporting multimodal input.

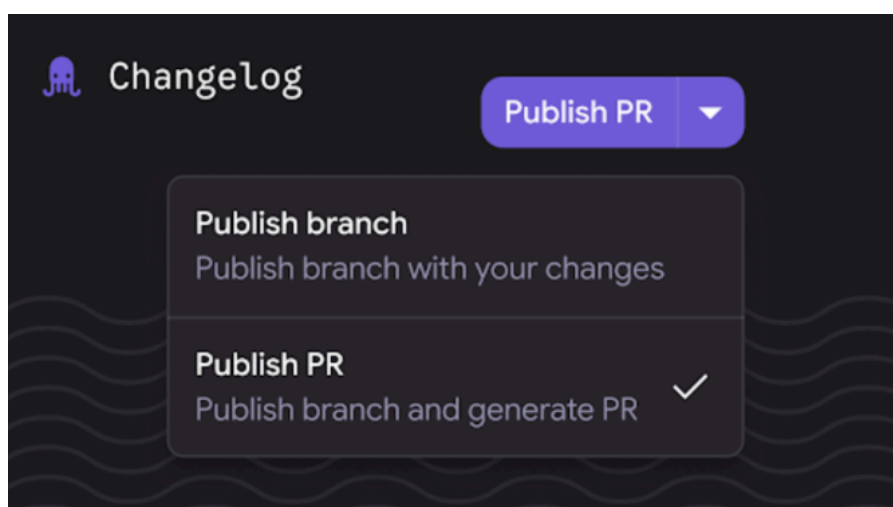


IMAGE CREDITS: JULES / X

The two primary users of Jules so far are the AI enthusiasts and professional developers, Korevec said.

By running asynchronously in a virtual machine, Jules stands apart from top AI coding tools like Cursor, Windsurf, and Lovable, which all work synchronously and require users to watch the output after each prompt.

“Jules operates like an extra set of hands ... you can basically kick off tasks to it, and then you could close your computer and walk away from it if you want and then come back hours later. Jules would have those tasks done for you, versus if you were

doing that with a local agent or using a synchronous agent, you would be bound to that session,” Korevec explained.

This week, Jules received a deeper integration with GitHub to [open pull requests automatically](#) — just like it could open branches — and a feature called [Environment Snapshots](#) to save dependencies and install scripts as a snapshot for faster, more consistent task execution.

From vibe coding to mobile use, beta trials informed Jules’ development

Since entering public beta, Jules has logged 2.28 million visits worldwide, 45% of them from mobile devices, per data from market intelligence provider [SimilarWeb](#), reviewed by TechCrunch. India was the top market for traffic, followed by the U.S. and Vietnam.

Google did not share specifics on Jules’ user base and its top geographies.

Korevec told TechCrunch that during the beta, the team observed that many people used Jules from traditional vibe-coding tools to either fix bugs that might have been implemented or extend the vibe-coded project to make it more production-ready.

Originally, Jules required users to have an existing codebase. But Google soon realized many potential users — like those trying other AI tools — might want to explore it without one. Korevec said the company quickly enabled Jules to work even with an empty repository. That helped increase its scope and usage.

Google Labs’ team also noticed an increasing number of users accessing Jules through their

mobile devices. Although the tool does not have a dedicated mobile app, Korevec said users were accessing it through its web app.

“Since it’s a big use case that we’re seeing emerging, we’re absolutely exploring what the features are that people need on mobile a lot more,” she noted.

Alongside beta testers, Korevec stated that Google already uses Jules to help develop some projects internally, and there is now a “big push” to use the tool on “a lot more projects” at the company.

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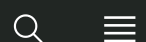
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Jagmeet covers startups, tech policy-related updates, and all other major tech-centric developments from India for...

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AI agents aren't the 'new Google,' says Airbnb CEO

Sarah Perez — 8:37 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

After a second-quarter earnings [beat](#), Airbnb CEO Brian Chesky shared his thoughts on the company's AI strategy, cautioning investors that AI chatbots can't yet be thought of as the "new Google." That is, AI chatbots, while potentially driving new leads to the travel and services business, aren't entirely a replacement for the referrals that the dominant search engine brings.

IMAGE CREDITS: [GERALD MATZKA](#) / [STRINGER](#)

At least not at this time.

"I think we're still kind of feeling out the space," the exec told investors on the Q2 earnings call. "The thing I want to caution is I don't think that AI agents — I don't think we should think of chatbots like Google — I don't think we should think of them as the 'new Google' yet."

This, Chesky explained, is because AI models aren't "proprietary."

"We also have to remember that the model powering ChatGPT is not proprietary. It's not exclusive to ChatGPT. We — Airbnb — can also use

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OpenAI's GPT-5 is here

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the API, and there are other models that we can use,” he said.

Painting a broader picture of the AI landscape, Chesky said that in addition to chatbots and other AI agents, there will be custom-built startups designed for specific applications, as well as other incumbents that have made the shift to AI.

“One of the things we’ve noticed is it’s not enough to just have ... the best model. You have to be able to tune the model and build a custom interface for the right application. And I think that’s the key,” he said.

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The company told investors it will look to take advantage of AI in a number of ways.

Airbnb shared during the call that its AI customer service agent in the U.S. reduced the percentage of guests contacting a human agent by 15%, for instance. This was actually harder than tackling the lower-hanging fruit involving travel planning and

Inspiration, Chesky said, because AI agents performing customer service can't hallucinate. They have to be accurate and helpful at all times.

Airbnb's customer service agent was built using 13 different models and trained on tens of thousands of conversations, and is currently available in English in the U.S. This year, Airbnb will roll it out to more languages, and next year, it will become more personalized and agentic. That means it would be able to understand if someone reaches out to cancel a reservation; not only would it be able to tell them how to do so, but it could also do it for them. The agent could also help plan and book trips.

Plus, AI will come to Airbnb's search next year, the CEO said.

However, the company has not fully fleshed out its plans for working with third-party AI agents, although it's considering it. Users still need an Airbnb account to make a booking.

Because of this, Chesky doesn't think agentic AI would turn its business into a commodity, the way that booking flights has become. Instead, he sees AI as "potentially interesting lead generation" for the company.

"I think the key thing is going to be for us to lead and become the first place for people to book travel on Airbnb. As far as whether or not we integrate with AI agents, I think that's something that we're certainly open to," he said.

Airbnb beat analysts' expectations in the quarter with revenue of \$3.1 billion and earnings per share of \$1.03, but the stock [dropped](#) on its forecast of slower growth in the second half of the year.



Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [🦋](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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OpenAI is practically giving ChatGPT to the government for free

Rebecca Bellan — 10:09 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

OpenAI is poised to undercut rivals like Anthropic and Google in the race to see its AI tools integrated into federal agency workflows.

The AI giant has [reached an agreement](#) with the U.S. General Services Administration (GSA), the government's central purchasing arm, to offer ChatGPT Enterprise to participating federal agencies for just \$1 per agency for the next year.

The partnership comes a day after the [GSA added OpenAI, Google, and Anthropic](#) to a list of approved AI vendors that can offer their services to civilian federal agencies. The companies will see their tools offered via the Multiple Award Schedule (MAS), a federal contracting platform that lets government agencies access AI tools via pre-negotiated contracts so they don't have to negotiate with vendors individually.

It's not clear whether other AI firms are going to offer their services at such a discounted rate, though GSA Federal Acquisition Service commissioner Josh Gruenbaum in a [statement](#) encouraged "other American AI technology companies to follow OpenAI's lead and work with us."

TechCrunch has reached out to Anthropic and Google for more information.

In addition to access to ChatGPT Enterprise, OpenAI is offering unlimited use of advanced models for an additional 60 days. Federal employees will also have access to a new government user community and tailored introductory training resources to get familiar with OpenAI's tools.

Data security is a top priority for government agencies that are concerned about sensitive information being leaked into model training sets. TechCrunch has asked the GSA for details on how

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government data is being safeguarded, including whether measures like on-premises or private cloud deployments are being used to enhance security.



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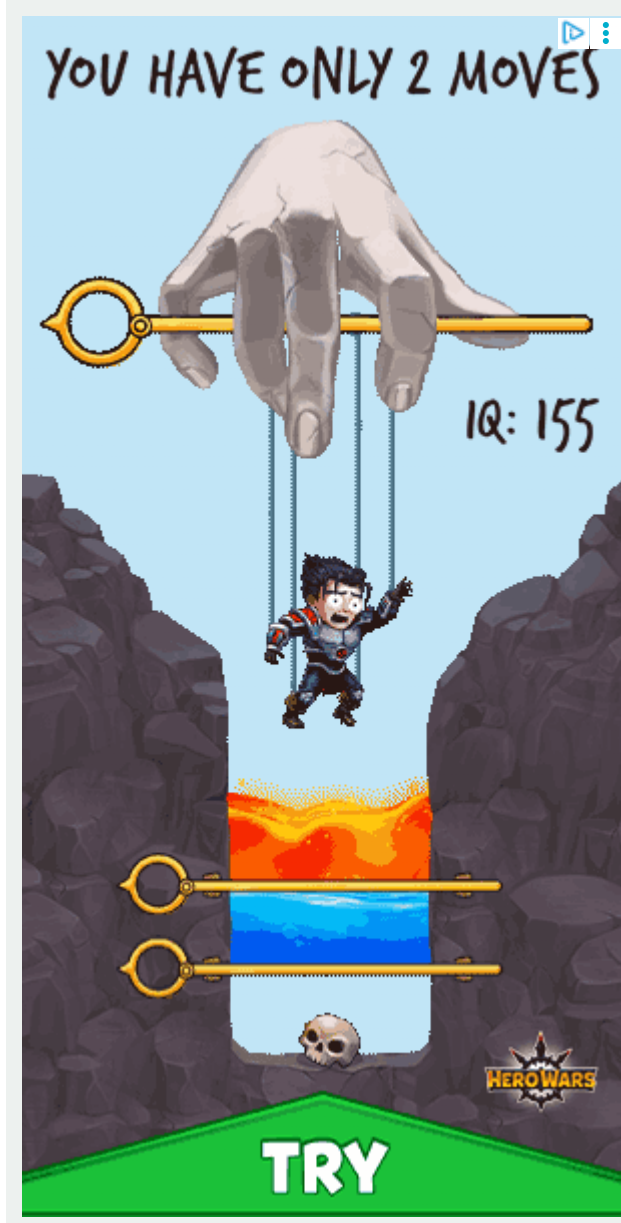
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“The government is taking a cautious, security-first approach to AI,” a GSA spokesperson told TechCrunch. “This ensures sensitive information remains protected while enabling agencies to benefit from AI-driven efficiencies.”

OpenAI's discount comes a couple of weeks after the Trump administration published its AI Action Plan that seeks to boost data center buildouts and integrate more AI tools into government, among other things. It also follows a Trump executive order that [bans “woke AI”](#) and AI models that aren't “ideologically neutral” from government contracts.

TechCrunch has reached out to OpenAI to learn more about its GSA partnership and how it will approach Trump's executive order.





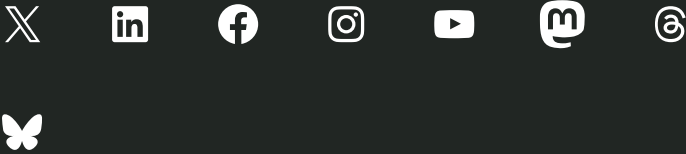
Rebecca Bellan

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Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch where she covers the business, policy, and emerging trends...

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